

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

1. Welcome and Company Values

Welcome to Acme Corporation Ltd. This handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and expectations that apply to all employees. Our core values are: Integrity, Innovation, Collaboration, and Customer Focus.

All employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally and to uphold these values in their daily work. Violation of company policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

2. Remote and Flexible Working

Employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval and role suitability. Remote work arrangements must be agreed in writing and reviewed every 6 months.

Core hours are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM, during which all employees must be available for meetings and collaboration regardless of their work location. Outside core hours, employees may flex their start and finish times between 7:00 AM and 7:00 PM.

Employees working remotely must have a suitable workspace, reliable internet connection (minimum 20 Mbps), and comply with all data security policies. The Company will provide a one-time £200 home office allowance for ergonomic equipment.

3. IT and Security Policies

Company laptops and devices must be used for work purposes only. Personal use is permitted to a reasonable extent but must not interfere with work duties or compromise security.

All devices must have full-disk encryption enabled. Passwords must be at least 12 characters and changed every 90 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all company systems.

Employees must not install unauthorized software, access blocked websites, or connect to unsecured Wi-Fi networks. Any suspected security breaches must be reported to the IT Security team immediately via security@acme.com.

The Company reserves the right to monitor usage of company devices and networks in accordance with applicable data protection laws.

4. Disciplinary and Grievance Procedures

The disciplinary process follows four stages: (1) Verbal warning, (2) First written warning, (3) Final written warning, (4) Dismissal. Each stage includes a formal meeting with the right to be accompanied by a colleague or union representative.

Warnings remain on file for 12 months (verbal and first written) or 18 months (final written) before being considered spent.

Employees who wish to raise a grievance should first attempt informal resolution with their manager. If unresolved, a formal grievance may be submitted in writing to the HR department. HR will arrange a hearing within 10 working days and provide a written outcome within 5 working days of the hearing.

5. Health and Safety

The Company is committed to providing a safe working environment. All employees must complete mandatory health and safety training within their first week of employment and attend annual refresher courses.

Employees must report all accidents, near-misses, and hazards to their manager and the Health & Safety Officer immediately. First aid kits are located on every floor, and trained first aiders are identified by green lanyards.

Display screen equipment (DSE) assessments will be conducted for all office-based employees upon request. Employees experiencing discomfort should request an assessment through HR.

6. Expenses and Travel

Business expenses must be submitted within 30 days of being incurred, using the Company's expense management system. Original receipts or digital copies are required for all claims above £10.

Mileage is reimbursed at 45p per mile for the first 10,000 miles, and 25p per mile thereafter. Hotel accommodation for business travel is capped at £150 per night (London) or £100 per night (elsewhere).

All travel must be booked through the Company's approved booking platform. Business class flights require VP-level approval for domestic travel and Director-level approval for international travel.

7. Equal Opportunities and Diversity

The Company is an equal opportunities employer. We are committed to eliminating discrimination and promoting diversity across all levels of the organization.

Discrimination, harassment, or victimization on the grounds of age, disability, gender, race, religion, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic will not be tolerated and may result in immediate dismissal.

The Company conducts annual pay gap analyses and publishes the results in accordance with regulatory requirements.